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(54) **OPTICAL MODULATOR, TRANSMITTING APPARATUS, COMMUNICATION SYSTEM, AND MODULATION METHOD**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

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An optical modulator, a transmitting apparatus, a communication system, and a modulation method are provided. The optical modulator includes a beam combiner/splitter, a first electro-optic phase shifter and a second electro-optic phase shifter that are connected to the beam combiner/splitter, a first reverser connected to the first electro-optic phase shifter, and a second reverser connected to the second electro-optic phase shifter. The beam combiner/splitter splits an input optical signal into a first optical signal and a second optical signal, inputs the first optical signal into the first electro-optic phase shifter, and inputs the second optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter. Because the first (second) reverser is disposed, the first (second) optical signal can be reversely transmitted after undergoing phase modulation once, so that the first (second) optical signal undergoes phase modulation twice back and forth in a phase modulation area of the first electro-optic phase shifter.

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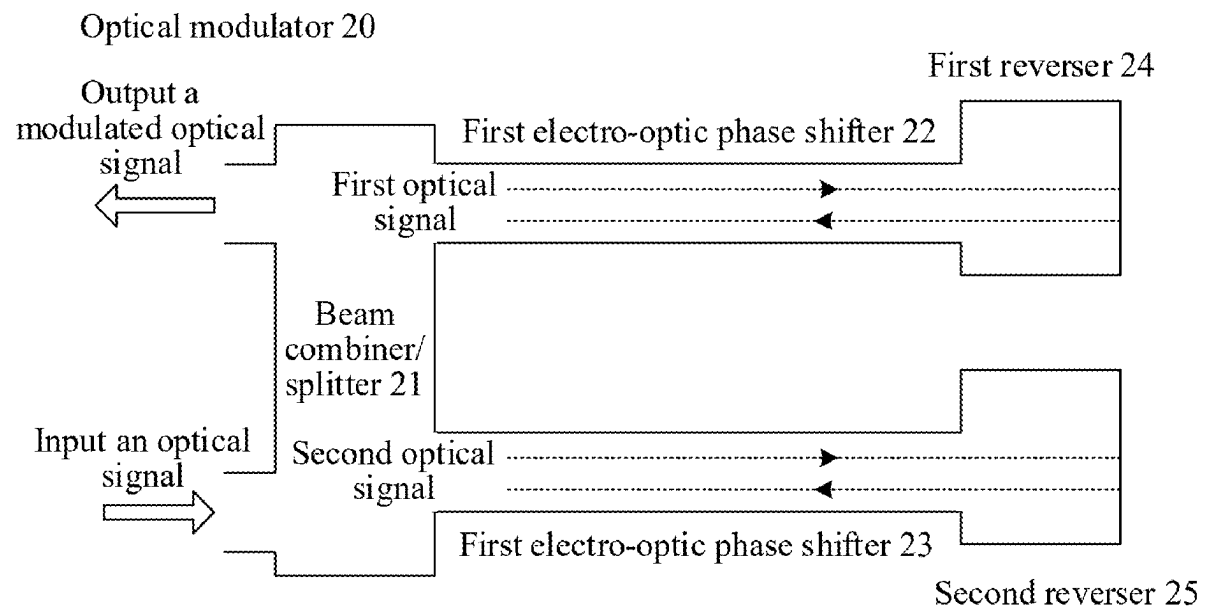
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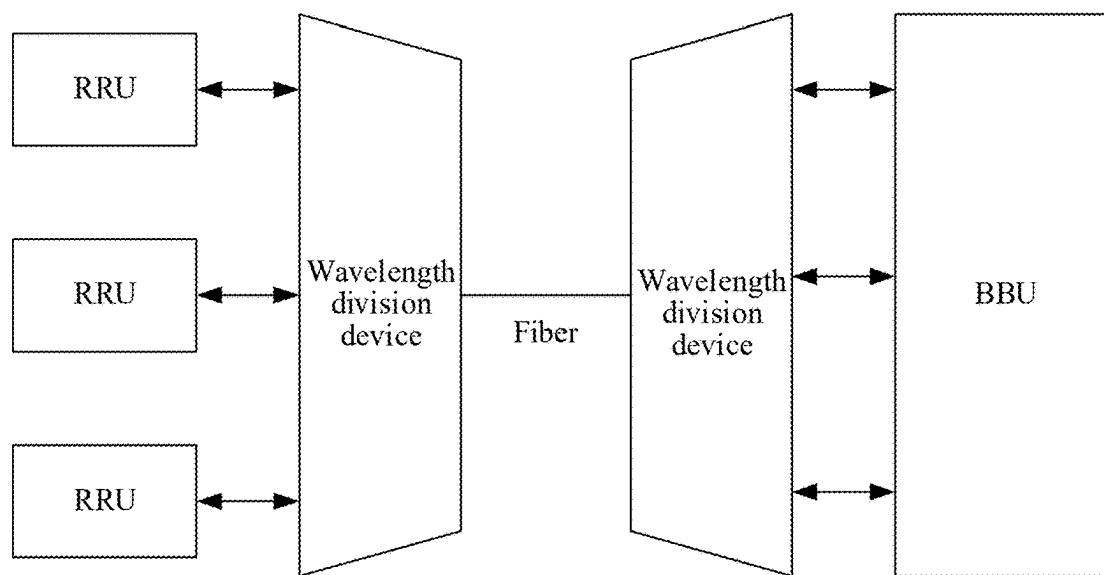


FIG. 1

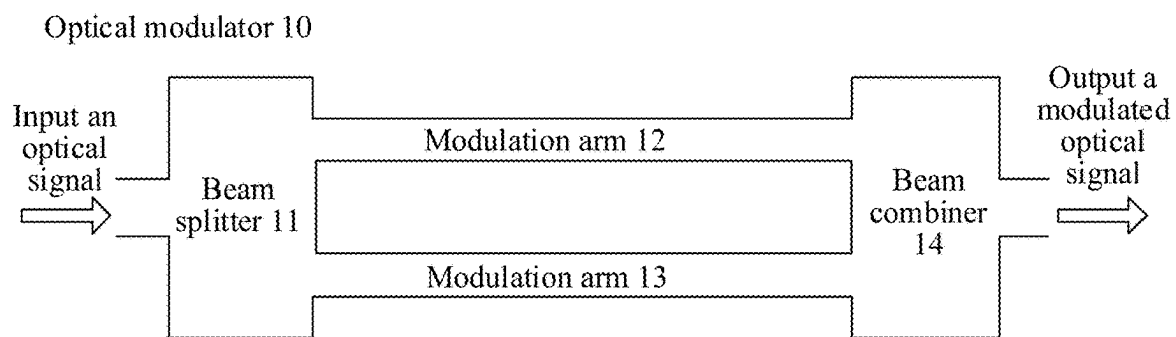


FIG. 2

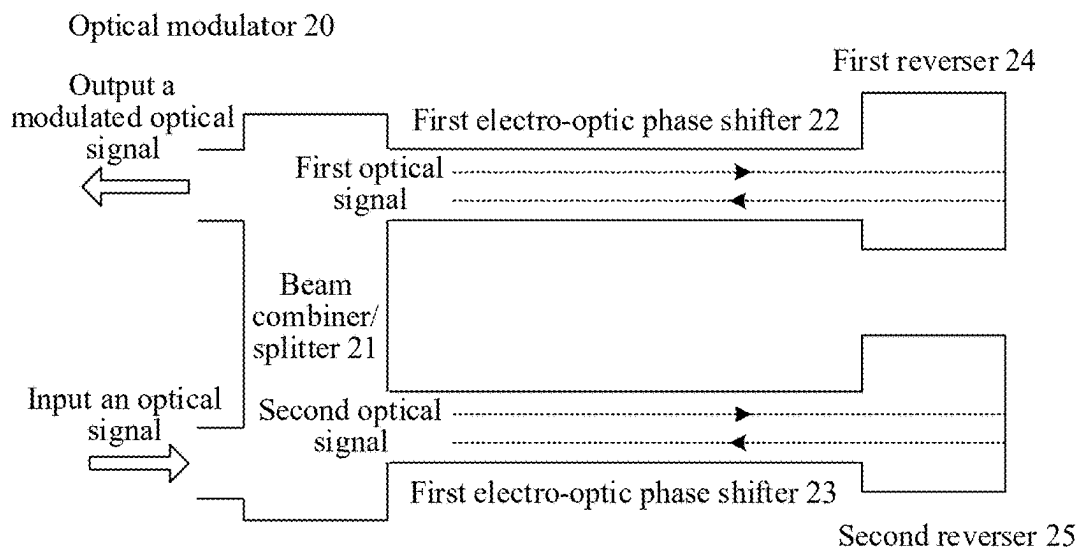


FIG. 3

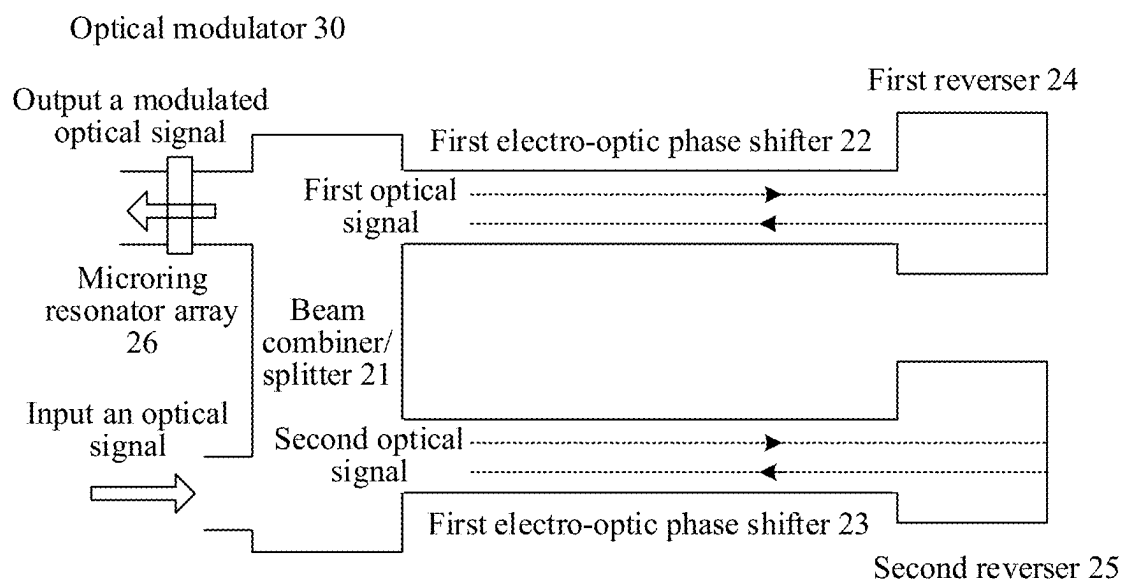


FIG. 4

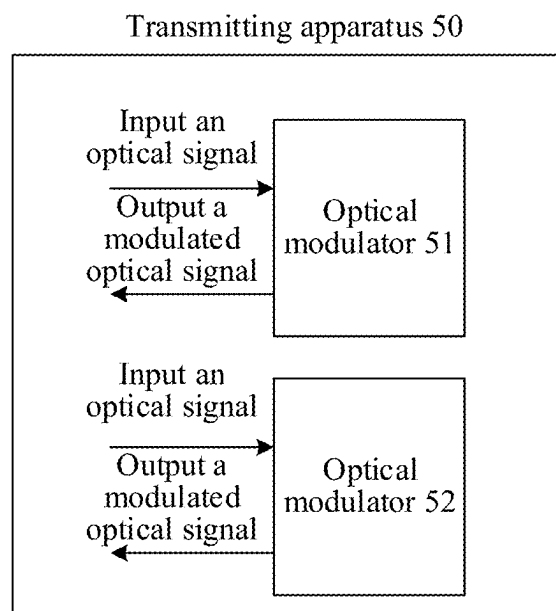


FIG. 5

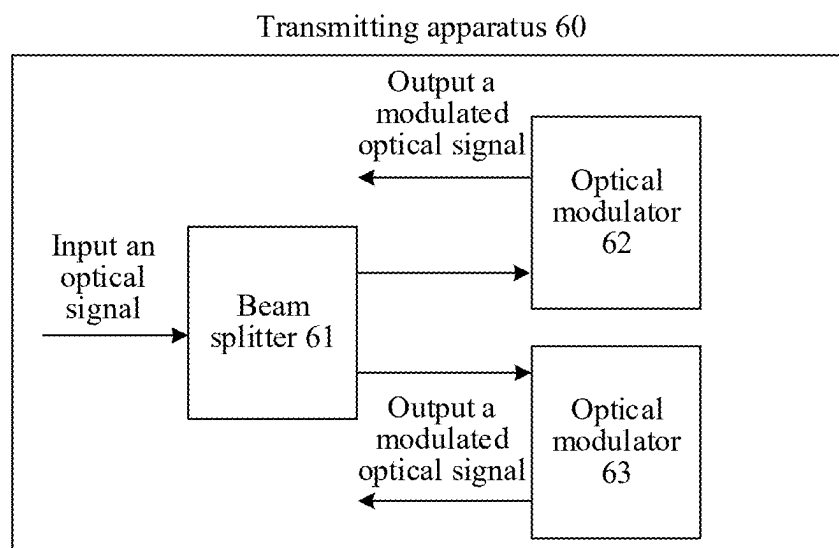


FIG. 6

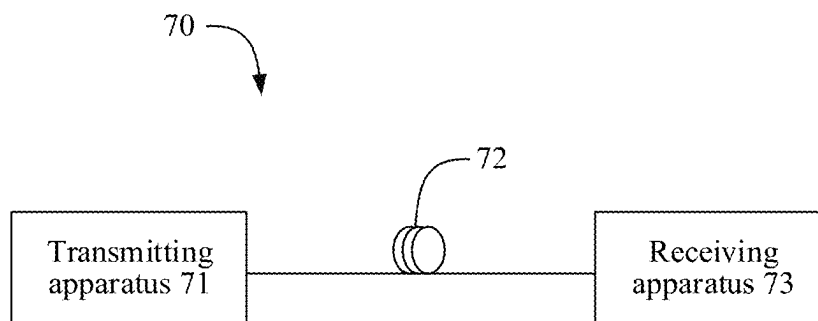


FIG. 7

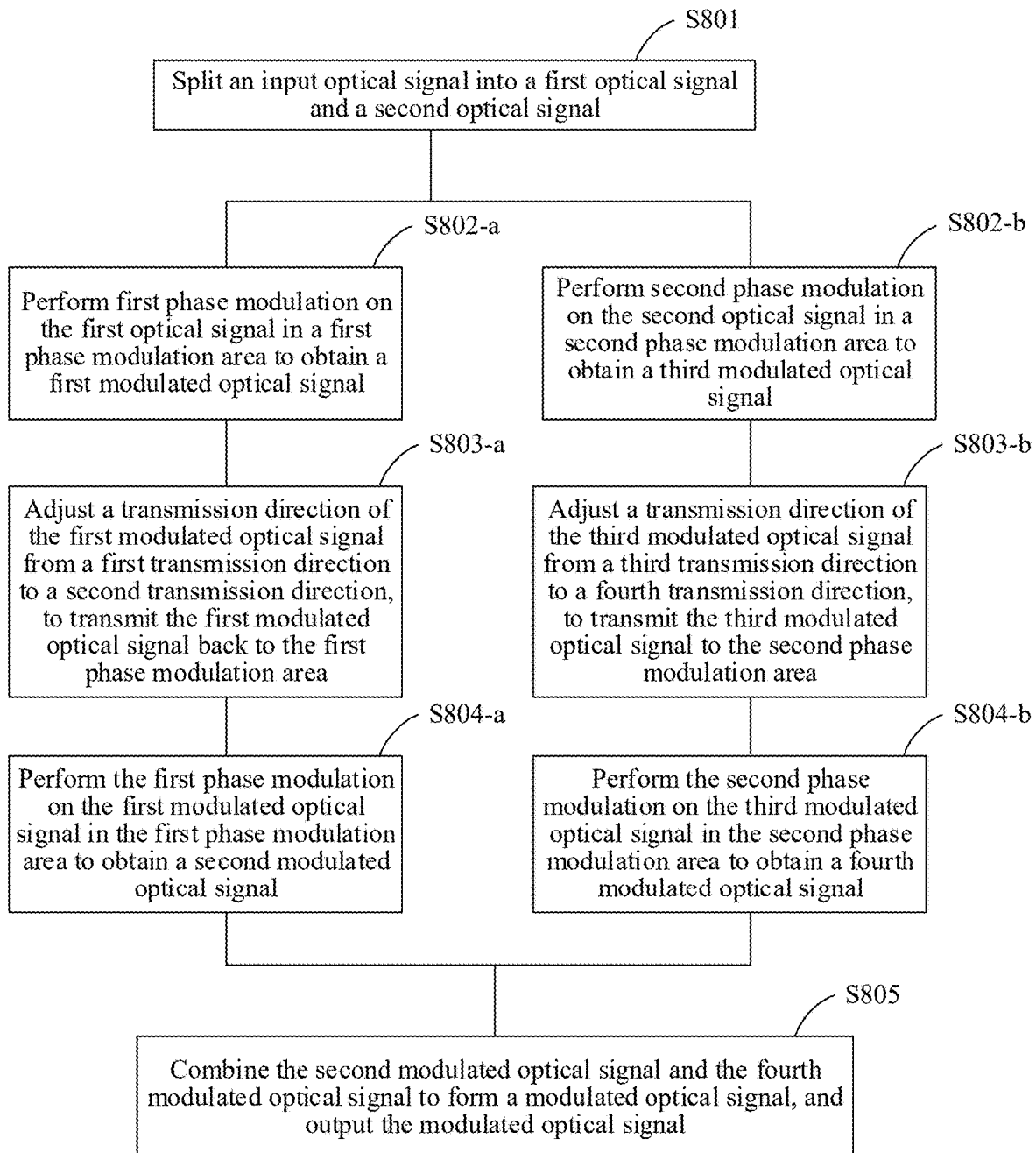


FIG. 8

OPTICAL MODULATOR, TRANSMITTING APPARATUS, COMMUNICATION SYSTEM, AND MODULATION METHOD

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application is a continuation of International Application No. PCT/CN2022/134808, filed on Nov. 28, 2022, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] This application relates to the field of communication technologies, and in particular, to an optical modulator, a transmitting apparatus, a communication system, and a modulation method.

BACKGROUND

[0003] With rapid development of communication technologies, modern communication has increasingly higher requirements for large-capacity and high-speed information. As a high-speed, high-bandwidth, and multi-dimensional transmission medium, light makes an optical communication technology develop rapidly. An optical modulator is an important active device in the optical communication field, and is widely used in optical transceiver module products. A working mode of the optical modulator is to convert a voltage modulation signal with a high or low change into a light intensity modulation signal with a high or low change. For example, the optical modulator is a Mach-Zehnder modulator (MZM).

[0004] However, because the optical modulator generally has a large size, for example, a silicon-based MZM is generally 1 to 3 millimeters (mm) long, and a lithium niobate MZM is approximately 1 centimeter (cm) long, the optical modulator is not highly integrated. This is non-conducive to development of miniaturization.

SUMMARY

[0005] This application provides an optical modulator, a transmitting apparatus, a communication system, and a modulation method, to reduce a size of the optical modulator and improve integration.

[0006] According to a first aspect, this application provides an optical modulator. The optical modulator includes a beam combiner/splitter, a first electro-optic phase shifter and a second electro-optic phase shifter that are connected to the beam combiner/splitter, a first reverser connected to the first electro-optic phase shifter, and a second reverser connected to the second electro-optic phase shifter.

[0007] When the optical modulator works, the beam combiner/splitter is configured to: split an input optical signal into a first optical signal and a second optical signal, input the first optical signal into the first electro-optic phase shifter, and input the second optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter.

[0008] The first electro-optic phase shifter is configured to: perform first phase modulation on the first optical signal to obtain a first modulated optical signal, and input the first modulated optical signal into the first reverser. The first reverser is configured to adjust a transmission direction of the first modulated optical signal from a first transmission direction to a second transmission direction, to input the first

modulated optical signal into the first electro-optic phase shifter, where the second transmission direction is opposite to the first transmission direction. The first electro-optic phase shifter is further configured to: perform the first phase modulation on the first modulated optical signal to obtain a second modulated optical signal, and input the second modulated optical signal into the beam combiner/splitter.

[0009] The second electro-optic phase shifter is configured to: perform second phase modulation on the second optical signal to obtain a third modulated optical signal, and input the third modulated optical signal into the second reverser. The second reverser is configured to adjust a transmission direction of the third modulated optical signal from a third transmission direction to a fourth transmission direction, to input the third modulated optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter, where the fourth transmission direction is opposite to the third transmission direction. The second electro-optic phase shifter is further configured to: perform the second phase modulation on the third modulated optical signal to obtain a fourth modulated optical signal, and input the fourth modulated optical signal into the beam combiner/splitter.

[0010] The beam combiner/splitter is further configured to: combine the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal to form a modulated optical signal, and output the modulated optical signal.

[0011] In this way, because the first reverser is disposed in the optical modulator, the first optical signal may be reversely transmitted after undergoing phase modulation once, so that the first optical signal undergoes phase modulation twice back and forth in a phase modulation area of the first electro-optic phase shifter (that is, a phase shift amount of the first optical signal is doubled). Similarly, because the second reverser is disposed in the optical modulator, the second optical signal may be reversely transmitted after undergoing phase modulation once, so that the second optical signal undergoes phase modulation twice back and forth in a phase modulation area of the second electro-optic phase shifter (that is, a phase shift amount of the second optical signal is doubled). However, in a conventional optical modulator, an optical signal only undergoes phase modulation once in a phase modulation area of a modulation arm. Therefore, compared with the conventional optical modulator, lengths of the phase modulation areas of the first electro-optic phase shifter and the second electro-optic phase shifter in the optical modulator may be halved, to effectively reduce a size of the optical modulator and improve integration.

[0012] In a possible design, the first reverser is a first reflector, a first waveguide loopback device, or a first grating structure, and the second reverser is a second reflector, a second waveguide loopback device, or a second grating structure.

[0013] In a possible design, a splitting ratio of the first optical signal to the second optical signal is 1:m, where $m > 0$ and $m \neq 1$. In other words, the beam combiner/splitter may split the input optical signal in an unequal ratio. In this way, after phase modulation is performed on the first optical signal and the second optical signal separately subsequently, because the first optical signal and the second optical signal are obtained through splitting of the unequal ratio, after the first optical signal and the second optical signal are combined, a phase deviation of the first optical signal and a phase deviation of the second optical signal are not completely

offset. Therefore, compared with the input optical signal, an optical signal that is finally output is superimposed with additional phase modulation, so that pre-compensation can be implemented.

[0014] In a possible design, the beam combiner/splitter is a multi-mode interferometer.

[0015] In a possible design, the optical modulator further includes a microring resonator array connected to the beam combiner/splitter, and the microring resonator array is configured to perform delay compensation on the modulated optical signal output by the beam combiner/splitter.

[0016] In this way, delay compensation is performed on the modulated optical signal by disposing the microring resonator array, to balance dispersion caused by a transmission link.

[0017] According to a second aspect, an embodiment of this application provides a transmitting apparatus. The transmitting apparatus includes the optical modulator according to any possible design of the first aspect.

[0018] According to a third aspect, an embodiment of this application provides a transmitting apparatus. The transmitting apparatus includes a beam splitter and N optical modulators connected to the beam splitter. The beam splitter is configured to: split an input optical signal into N optical signals, and respectively input the N optical signals into the N optical modulators. An i^{th} optical modulator in the N optical modulators is configured to: perform phase modulation on an i^{th} optical signal in the N optical signals, and output an i^{th} modulated optical signal, where $i=1, 2, \dots, N$, and N is an integer greater than 1.

[0019] In a possible design, the N optical signals have a same splitting ratio.

[0020] In a possible design, the N optical modulators include the optical modulator according to any possible design of the first aspect.

[0021] According to a fourth aspect, an embodiment of this application provides a communication system. The communication system includes a receiving apparatus, a fiber link, and the transmitting apparatus according to the second aspect or the third aspect. The fiber link connects the transmitting apparatus and the receiving apparatus.

[0022] According to a fifth aspect, an embodiment of this application provides a modulation method. The method may be applied to the optical modulator in the first aspect. The method includes: splitting an input optical signal into a first optical signal and a second optical signal; performing, in a first phase modulation area, first phase modulation on the first optical signal to obtain a first modulated optical signal; adjusting a transmission direction of the first modulated optical signal from a first transmission direction to a second transmission direction, to transmit the first modulated optical signal to the first phase modulation area, where the second transmission direction is opposite to the first transmission direction; and performing, in the first phase modulation area, the first phase modulation on the first modulated optical signal to obtain a second modulated optical signal; performing, in a second phase modulation area, second phase modulation on the second optical signal to obtain a third modulated optical signal; adjusting a transmission direction of the third modulated optical signal from a third transmission direction to a fourth transmission direction, to transmit the third modulated optical signal to the second phase modulation area, where the fourth transmission direction is opposite to the third transmission direction; and

performing, in the second phase modulation area, the second phase modulation on the third modulated optical signal to obtain a fourth modulated optical signal; and combining the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal to form a modulated optical signal, and outputting the modulated optical signal.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0023] FIG. 1 is a diagram of wavelength division multiplexing according to an embodiment of this application;

[0024] FIG. 2 is a diagram of a conventional optical modulator (for example, an MZM) according to an embodiment of this application;

[0025] FIG. 3 is a diagram of a structure of an optical modulator according to Embodiment 1 of this application;

[0026] FIG. 4 is a diagram of a structure of an optical modulator according to Embodiment 2 of this application;

[0027] FIG. 5 is a diagram of a structure of a transmitting apparatus according to Embodiment 3 of this application;

[0028] FIG. 6 is a diagram of another structure of a transmitting apparatus according to Embodiment 3 of this application;

[0029] FIG. 7 is a diagram of a communication system according to an embodiment of this application; and

[0030] FIG. 8 is a schematic flowchart corresponding to a modulation method according to an embodiment of this application.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

[0031] The following describes the technical solutions in embodiments of this application with reference to the accompanying drawings in embodiments of this application.

[0032] With rapid development of communication technologies, a quantity of mobile users and a service volume increase rapidly, and a quantity of radio access network devices (for example, base stations) increases sharply. To optimize a network architecture, in a wireless fronthaul scenario, a centralized radio access network (C-RAN) becomes a mainstream application. A C-RAN network architecture can implement centralized management of a building baseband unit (BBU). The BBU and a radio frequency unit are connected through a fiber, and the radio frequency unit is, for example, a remote radio unit (RRU).

[0033] Because the BBU and the RRU are generally far away from each other, to save fiber resources, a wavelength division multiplexing (WDM) technology may be used to implement fiber multiplexing. As shown in FIG. 1, a plurality of radio frequency units may be connected to a BBU by multiplexing one fiber through a wavelength division device, to improve fiber utilization. In addition, main fibers connected to the radio frequency units that perform fiber multiplexing through the same wavelength division device (fibers between a wavelength division device on a radio frequency unit side and a wavelength division device on the BBU side) are the same, and only lengths of pigtailed between the wavelength division device on the radio frequency unit side and the radio frequency units may be different.

[0034] The WDM technology may also be referred to as an optical wavelength multiplexing technology, and is a data transmission technology of combining optical signals with two or more different wavelengths using a multiplexer at a transmitting end and coupling combined signals to a same fiber for sending, and separating optical signals with various

wavelengths using a de-multiplexer at a receive end. A basic principle is that different optical signals are carried in different colors (wavelength frequencies) and then multiplexed onto one fiber for transmission. Common wavelength division multiplexing includes coarse wavelength division multiplexing (CWDM), dense wavelength division multiplexing (DWDM), LAN-wavelength division multiplexing (LWDM), and the like.

[0035] The wavelength division device is a device of using the WDM technology to support transmission of optical signals with two or more different wavelengths in one fiber. For example, the wavelength division device may be a CWDM wavelength division device, a DWDM wavelength division device, or an LWDM wavelength division device. The wavelength division device may standardize wavelengths of optical modules of the radio frequency unit and the BBU, and different wavelength division devices have different specifications for the wavelengths of the optical modules of the radio frequency unit and a BBU port. For example, the wavelength division device is a 6-wavelength CWDM wavelength division device. According to a specification of the 6-wavelength CWDM wavelength division device for a wavelength of an optical module, the wavelength of the optical module of the radio frequency unit may be 1271, 1291, or 1311 (unit: nanometer (nm)), and the wavelength of the optical module of the BBU may be 1331, 1351, or 1371 (unit: nanometer).

[0036] For example, the BBU sends a signal. The optical module of the BBU may include three optical modulators. The three optical modulators modulate optical signals with three wavelengths (1331 nm, 1351 nm, or 1371 nm), and input modulated optical signals to the wavelength division device, for the wavelength division device to transmit the optical signals with the three wavelengths to different radio frequency units through one fiber.

[0037] FIG. 2 is a diagram of a conventional optical modulator (for example, an MZM). As shown in FIG. 2, the conventional optical modulator 10 may include a beam splitter 11, and a modulation arm disposed on each branch of the beam splitter 11. Refer to FIG. 2. During disposition, the beam splitter 11 has two symmetrically disposed branches, that is, two symmetrically disposed modulation arms (a modulation arm 12 and a modulation arm 13). Further, the conventional optical modulator 10 further includes a beam combiner 14 connected to the two modulation arms.

[0038] In one embodiment, after receiving an input optical signal, the beam splitter 11 splits the optical signal into two light beams, namely, two optical signals, with equal power (that is, a splitting ratio of the two optical signals is 1:1). For example, the two optical signals are an optical signal a and an optical signal b. The optical signal a is input to the modulation arm 12, and the optical signal b is input to the modulation arm 13. Further, the modulation arm 12 performs phase modulation on the optical signal a to obtain a modulated optical signal a, and inputs the modulated optical signal a into the beam combiner 14. The modulation arm 13 performs phase modulation on the optical signal b to obtain a modulated optical signal b, and inputs the modulated optical signal b into the beam combiner 14. The beam combiner 14 combines the modulated optical signal a and the adjusted optical signal b, and outputs an optical signal obtained through beam combination.

[0039] A conventional optical modulator uses an optical interference principle to convert phase modulation into intensity modulation. In one embodiment, when phases of two light beams output by the two modulation arms are the same, according to an interference theory of light, constructive interference occurs during beam combination, and output light intensity is the largest, which may be considered as a high-level signal. When a phase difference exists between two light beams output by the two modulation arms, light intensity is not the largest after beam combination is interfered with. If the phase difference is x , interference is canceled, and output light intensity is the smallest, which may be considered as a low-level signal. In this way, constructive or destructive interference of light intensity is formed based on a phase difference between two light beams. This causes a change in intensity, to modulate an optical signal.

[0040] However, the conventional optical modulator is generally large in size. A lithium niobate MZM is used as an example. The lithium niobate MZM performs local doping on a monocrystalline lithium niobate material by using a titanium diffusion or proton exchange process, to form a waveguide. A refractive index difference between a core layer and a cladding layer of the waveguide is very small, and the waveguide has a poor binding capability on a light field. In addition, to achieve performance of a low drive voltage, a length of a phase modulation area needs to be designed to be very long. Therefore, a size of a packaged optical modulator is large, which leads to insufficient integration and is not conducive to miniaturization development.

[0041] In view of this, in embodiments of this application, a structure of the conventional optical modulator is improved. A reverser is introduced into the optical modulator, so that an optical signal undergoes phase modulation twice back and forth in a phase modulation area. This helps reduce a length of the phase modulation area, to reduce a size of the optical modulator and improve integration.

[0042] For example, an optical modulator provided in embodiments of this application may be manufactured on a chip, or may be directly assembled in an optical module. The optical modulator provided in embodiments of this application may be used in a communication device in a communication scenario like wireless fronthaul, midhaul backhaul, a data center, an access network, or a backbone network. For example, the optical modulator provided in embodiments of this application may be used in the foregoing BBU (for example, assembled in the optical module of the BBU).

Embodiment 1

[0043] FIG. 3 is a diagram of a structure of an optical modulator according to Embodiment 1 of this application. As shown in FIG. 3, an optical modulator 20 may include: a beam combiner/splitter 21, a first electro-optic phase shifter 22 and a second electro-optic phase shifter 23 that are connected to the beam combiner/splitter 21 (that is, the first electro-optic phase shifter 22 and the second electro-optic phase shifter 23 are located on two branches of the beam combiner/splitter 21), a first reverser 24 connected to the first electro-optic phase shifter 22, and a second reverser 25 connected to the second electro-optic phase shifter 23.

[0044] The beam combiner/splitter 21 is configured to: split an input optical signal into a first optical signal and a second optical signal, input the first optical signal into the

first electro-optic phase shifter **22**, and input the second optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter **23**. For example, an input end of the beam combiner/splitter **21** may be connected to a laser, and the laser is configured to input the optical signal to the beam combiner/splitter **21**. In a possible implementation, the laser may be a continuous wave (CW) laser.

[0045] The first electro-optic phase shifter **22** is configured to: perform first phase modulation on the first optical signal to obtain a first modulated optical signal, and input the first modulated optical signal into the first reverser **24**.

[0046] The first reverser **24** is configured to adjust a transmission direction of the first modulated optical signal from a first transmission direction to a second transmission direction, to input the first modulated optical signal into the first electro-optic phase shifter **22**, where the second transmission direction is opposite to the first transmission direction.

[0047] The first electro-optic phase shifter **22** is further configured to: perform the first phase modulation on the first modulated optical signal to obtain a second modulated optical signal, and input the second modulated optical signal into the beam combiner/splitter **21**.

[0048] The second electro-optic phase shifter **23** is configured to: perform second phase modulation on the second optical signal to obtain a third modulated optical signal, and input the third modulated optical signal into the second reverser **25**.

[0049] The second reverser **25** is configured to adjust a transmission direction of the third modulated optical signal from a third transmission direction to a fourth transmission direction, to input the third modulated optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter **23**, where the fourth transmission direction is opposite to the third transmission direction.

[0050] The second electro-optic phase shifter **23** is further configured to: perform the second phase modulation on the third modulated optical signal to obtain a fourth modulated optical signal, and input the fourth modulated optical signal into the beam combiner/splitter **21**. The beam combiner/splitter **21** is further configured to: combine the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal to form a modulated optical signal, and output the modulated optical signal.

[0051] In this way, in one aspect, because the first reverser **24** is disposed in the optical modulator **20**, the first optical signal may be reversely transmitted after undergoing phase modulation once, so that the first optical signal undergoes phase modulation twice back and forth in the phase modulation area of the first electro-optic phase shifter **22** (that is, a phase shift amount of the first optical signal is doubled). Similarly, because the second reverser **25** is disposed in the optical modulator **20**, the second optical signal may be reversely transmitted after undergoing phase modulation once, so that the second optical signal undergoes phase modulation twice back and forth in the phase modulation area of the second electro-optic phase shifter **23** (that is, a phase shift amount of the second optical signal is doubled). However, in the conventional optical modulator **10**, an optical signal only undergoes phase modulation once in a phase modulation area of the modulation arm. Therefore, compared with the conventional optical modulator **10**, lengths of the phase modulation areas of the first electro-optic phase shifter **22** and the second electro-optic phase

shifter **23** in the optical modulator **20** may be halved, to effectively reduce a size of the optical modulator and improve integration.

[0052] In addition, when the lengths of the phase modulation areas of the first electro-optic phase shifter **22** and the second electro-optic phase shifter **23** are halved, an electrical signal loss can be effectively reduced (a longer length of the phase modulation area indicates a larger electrical signal loss), so that an amplitude requirement on a drive electrical signal in the first electro-optic phase shifter **22** and the second electro-optic phase shifter **23** is reduced.

[0053] In another aspect, optical ports (namely, an input port of an optical signal and an output port of a modulated optical signal) in the optical modulator **20** are located on the beam combiner/splitter **21**, that is, the input port of the optical signal and the output port of the modulated optical signal are on a same side. In the conventional optical modulator **10**, an input port of an optical signal is located on the beam splitter **11**, and an output port of a modulated optical signal is located on the beam combiner **14**, that is, the input port of the optical signal and the output port of the modulated optical signal are located on two sides of the modulation arm. Therefore, compared with the conventional optical modulator **10**, the optical modulator **20** can reduce a trace loss and reduce optical port coupling difficulty and a quantity of fiber arrays (FA) by disposing the optical ports on a same side.

[0054] The following separately describes components included in the optical modulator **20**.

(1) Beam Combiner/Splitter **21**

[0055] For example, the beam combiner/splitter **21** may be a multi-mode interferometer (MMI). For example, the beam combiner/splitter **21** is a 2*2 MMI. One side of the 2*2 MMI has two ports: a port 1 and a port 2, and correspondingly, and the other side of the 2*2 MMI also has two ports: a port 3 and a port 4. The port 1 is configured to input an optical signal, the port 2 is configured to output a modulated optical signal, the port 3 is configured to output the first optical signal, and the port 4 is configured to output the second optical signal.

[0056] For example, in one embodiment, a direct-current phase difference between the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal may be controlled by adjusting a working point of the optical modulator **20** and/or a difference between the lengths of the phase modulation area of the first electro-optic phase shifter **22** and the phase modulation area of the second electro-optic phase shifter **23**, so that the modulated optical signal obtained through combination of the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal may be output from another port of the 2*2 MMI, and no backflow is formed on an input port.

[0057] It may be understood that, in another possible embodiment, the beam combiner/splitter **21** may alternatively be another possible interferometer, for example, a Mach-Zehnder interferometer (MZI). This is not particularly limited.

[0058] In a possible implementation, the beam combiner/splitter **21** may split the input optical signal into the first optical signal and the second optical signal based on a splitting ratio of 1:m, where $m > 0$ and $m \neq 1$. In other words, the beam combiner/splitter **21** may split the input optical signal in an unequal ratio. In this way, after phase modula-

tion is performed on the first optical signal and the second optical signal separately subsequently, because the first optical signal and the second optical signal are obtained through splitting of the unequal ratio, after the first optical signal and the second optical signal are combined, a phase deviation of the first optical signal and a phase deviation of the second optical signal are not completely offset. Therefore, compared with the input optical signal, an optical signal that is finally output is superimposed with additional phase modulation, so that pre-compensation can be implemented.

[0059] It may be understood that pre-compensation described in embodiments of this application may occur before a fiber link, that is, the optical signal is modulated before dispersion occurs. For example, the optical modulator 20 is disposed on a transmitting apparatus side, that is, phase modulation is performed on the optical signal on the transmitting apparatus side. Therefore, after the optical signal output by the optical modulator 20 enters the fiber link, even if dispersion occurs in the optical signal in the fiber link, because pre-compensation is performed for the optical signal before the optical signal enters the fiber link, a problem caused by dispersion can be effectively reduced.

[0060] The following describes in detail, through mathematical derivation, dispersion compensation performed by the optical modulator 20 on the optical signal in this application. In the optical modulator 20 in this application, an electric field of the first optical signal is:

$$E_1 = Ae^{ix(t)} \quad (1)$$

[0061] An electric field of the second optical signal is:

$$E_2 = Be^{-ix(t)} \quad (2)$$

[0062] $x(t)$ represents a composite signal. In the optical modulator 20 in this application, $x(t)$ represents a composite signal obtained through joint acting of a real signal $s(t)$ and a direct current bias b (different direct current biases correspond to different working points), that is:

$$x(t) = s(t) + b \quad (3)$$

[0063] In the foregoing formulas (1) and (2), A is a component corresponding to the first optical signal output by the beam combiner/splitter 21, and B is a component corresponding to the second optical signal output by the beam combiner/splitter 21. A , B , and m satisfy the following formula: $A: B=1:m$. When $m=1$, $A=B$. In addition, A and B further satisfy the following formula:

$$A^2 + B^2 = 1 \quad (4)$$

[0064] According to the foregoing formulas (1), (2), (3), and (4), an electric field obtained through combination of the first optical signal and the second optical signal is:

$$E = E_1 + E_2 = (A + B)\cos x(t) + i(A - B)\sin x(t) \quad (5)$$

[0065] Because the working point is in a linear area (in the linear area, because a mapping function relationship between an electrical signal and an optical signal is a simple linear relationship, after information carried in the electrical signal is modulated into the optical signal, the information does not change or be distorted, and because a relationship between a direct current bias voltage and output optical power of the optical modulator is similar to a sin curve, if the working point is at a middle position of the sin curve (for example, positions of $\sin 0$ and $\sin \pi$), it is considered that the optical modulator works in the linear area), the formula (5) may be approximately as follows:

$$E = (A + B)x(t) + i(A - B)x(t) \quad (6)$$

[0066] When the optical modulator 20 is used in a communication system, an example in which the optical signal is transmitted in a 10-km fiber link is used. It is assumed that a transfer function generated by dispersion effect is h . An electric field of an optical signal received by a receiving apparatus is:

$$\begin{aligned} E(t) &= E \otimes h \\ &= (A + B)[s(t) \otimes h] + (A + B)b + i(B - A)[s(t) \otimes h] - i(B - A)b \end{aligned} \quad (7)$$

[0067] According to the foregoing formula (7), strength of the optical signal received by the receiving apparatus is:

$$\begin{aligned} I(t) &= |E(t)|^2 \\ &= [(A + B)\text{Re}[s(t) \otimes h] + (A + B)b + (A - B)\text{Im}[s(t) \otimes h]]^2 + \\ &\quad [(A + B)\text{Im}[s(t) \otimes h] + (B - A)\text{Re}[s(t) \otimes h] + (A - B)b]^2 \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

[0068] If the constant terms in the foregoing formula (8) are ignored, the following formula may be obtained:

$$\begin{aligned} I(t) &= 2(\text{Re}[s(t) \otimes h]^2 + \text{Im}[s(t) \otimes h]^2) + \\ &\quad 8ABb * \text{Re}[s(t) \otimes h] + 4(A^2 - B^2)b * \text{Im}[s(t) \otimes h] \end{aligned} \quad (9)$$

[0069] In the foregoing formula (9), because a high-order term is an error generated by approximation of a former term, the high-order term may be ignored. Therefore, a fast Fourier transform (FFT) is performed on $I(t)$, and a result obtained through fast Fourier transform is substituted into the following formula:

$$H(\omega) = \cos(\omega^2 \beta L / 2) + i \sin(\omega^2 \beta L / 2) \quad (10)$$

[0070] The following formula may be obtained:

$$I(\omega) = 8ABb \cdot S(\omega) \cdot \cos(\omega^2 \beta L/2) + 4(A^2 - B^2)b \cdot S(\omega) \cdot \sin(\omega^2 \beta L/2) \quad (11)$$

[0071] When the splitting ratio of the beam combiner/splitter **21** is 1, if $m=1$ and $A=B$, $I(\omega)=8ABb \cdot S(\omega) \cdot \cos(\omega^2 \beta L/2)$. The optical signal undergoes cos filtering effect caused by dispersion.

[0072] When the splitting ratio of the beam combiner/splitter **21** is not equal to 1, $m \neq 1$, that is, $A \neq B$. In this case, the part $4(A^2 - B^2)b \cdot S(\omega) \cdot \sin(\omega^2 \beta L/2)$ in $I(\omega)$ is not zero, and dispersion compensation can be implemented. In addition, a positive compensation direction or a negative compensation direction of the optical signal may be controlled based on a relative value of A and B.

(2) First Electro-Optic Phase Shifter **22** and Second Electro-Optic Phase Shifter **23**

[0073] For example, the first electro-optic phase shifter **22** may include a first traveling wave electrode. The first electro-optic phase shifter **22** may load a high-speed electrical signal to the phase modulation area (referred to as a first phase modulation area) of the first electro-optic phase shifter **22** through the first traveling wave electrode, and change a refractive index in the first phase modulation area by changing a carrier concentration in a waveguide of the first phase modulation area, to perform first phase modulation on an optical signal that passes through the first phase modulation area.

[0074] The second electro-optic phase shifter **23** may include a second traveling wave electrode. The second electro-optic phase shifter **23** may load a high-speed electrical signal to the phase modulation area (referred to as a second phase modulation area) of the second electro-optic phase shifter **23** through the second traveling wave electrode, and change a refractive index in the second phase modulation area by changing a carrier concentration in a waveguide of the second phase modulation area, to perform second phase modulation on an optical signal that passes through the second phase modulation area.

[0075] It may be understood that the first phase modulation and the second phase modulation may be the same, or may be different. In actual application, the first phase modulation and the second phase modulation may be set based on factors such as a fiber link and a transmission distance, so that quality of the optical signal received by the receiving apparatus is better.

(3) First Reverser **24** and Second Reverser **25**

[0076] The first reverser **24** and the second reverser **25** may be of structures that enable optical signals to be reversely transmitted. For example, the first reverser **24** may be a first reflector, a first waveguide loopback device, or a first grating structure, and the second reverser **25** may be a second reflector, a second waveguide loopback device, or a second grating structure.

[0077] It may be understood that the first reverser **24** and the second reverser **25** may be of independent structures, for example, the first reverser **24** and the second reverser **25** are two independent reflectors respectively; or the first reverser

24 and the second reverser **25** may be of an integrated structure, for example, the first reverser **24** and the second reverser **25** are a same reflector.

Embodiment 2

[0078] FIG. 4 is a diagram of a structure of an optical modulator according to Embodiment 2 of this application. As shown in FIG. 4, an optical modulator **30** may include a beam combiner/splitter **21**, a first electro-optic phase shifter **22** and a second electro-optic phase shifter **23** that are connected to the beam combiner/splitter **21**, a first reverser **24** connected to the first electro-optic phase shifter **22**, a second reverser **25** connected to the second electro-optic phase shifter **23**, and a microring resonator array **26** connected to the beam combiner/splitter **21**. Compared with the optical modulator **20** shown in FIG. 2, the optical modulator **30** shown in FIG. 4 further includes the microring resonator array **26**. For content other than this difference, refer to the descriptions in Embodiment 1.

[0079] In the optical modulator **30**, the microring resonator array **26** is configured to perform delay compensation on a modulated optical signal output by the beam combiner/splitter **21**. Different degrees of delay compensation may be applied to optical signals with different wavelengths, so that dispersion compensation effect can be further enhanced (that is, dispersion may be compensated for by setting an unequal splitting ratio and the microring resonator array), to balance dispersion caused by a transmission link.

[0080] For example, the microring resonator array **26** may include one microring resonator (which may also be referred to as a microring for short), or may include a plurality of microring resonators. When the microring resonator array **26** includes a plurality of microring resonators, the plurality of microring resonators may be connected in series or in parallel. This is not particularly limited. For example, the microring resonator array **26** includes one microring. The microring may be a thermally adjusted microring. In other words, a delay imposed by the microring on an optical signal may be adjusted by controlling a temperature.

Embodiment 3

[0081] FIG. 5 is a diagram of a structure of a transmitting apparatus according to Embodiment 3 of this application. As shown in FIG. 5, a transmitting apparatus **50** includes one or more optical modulators. FIG. 5 shows two optical modulators (namely, an optical modulator **51** and an optical modulator **52**) included in the transmitting apparatus **50**. The optical modulator **51** or the optical modulator **52** may be the optical modulator **20** in Embodiment 1, or may be the optical modulator **30** in Embodiment 2.

[0082] The optical modulator **51** and the optical modulator **52** may work independently. For example, the optical modulator **51** may modulate an optical signal with a first wavelength (for example, 1331 nm), and output a modulated optical signal. The optical modulator **52** may modulate an optical signal with a second wavelength (for example, 1351 nm), and output a modulated optical signal.

[0083] FIG. 6 is a diagram of another structure of a transmitting apparatus according to Embodiment 3 of this application. As shown in FIG. 6, a transmitting apparatus **60** includes a beam splitter **61** and N optical modulators connected to the beam splitter **61**. In FIG. 6, N=2 is used as an example for illustration. The N optical modulators are

respectively an optical modulator 62 and an optical modulator 63. The optical modulator 62 or the optical modulator 63 may be the optical modulator 20 in Embodiment 1, or may be the optical modulator 30 in Embodiment 2.

[0084] The beam splitter 61 is configured to: split an input optical signal into N optical signals, and respectively input the N optical signals into the N optical modulators. An i^{th} optical modulator in the N optical modulators is configured to: perform phase modulation on an i^{th} optical signal in the N optical signals, and output an i^{th} modulated optical signal, where $i=1, 2, \dots, N$, and N is an integer greater than 1. For example, the N optical signals have a same splitting ratio, that is, a splitting ratio of the N optical signals is 1:1.

[0085] In other words, the beam splitter 61 splits the input optical signal into the N optical signals, and the N optical signals respectively enter the N optical modulators for phase modulation, so that the N optical modulators may respectively output modulated optical signals. Splitting ratios corresponding to the N optical modulators may be the same or may be different. When the splitting ratios corresponding to the N optical modulators are different, different transmission distances may be adapted, so that signal transmission is more flexible.

[0086] Through use of the structure shown in FIG. 6, the N optical modulators in the transmitting apparatus may multiplex a same input end through the beam splitter, that is, the N optical modulators may modulate optical signals with a same wavelength, and respectively output modulated optical signals, to improve integration.

[0087] Based on the transmitting apparatus shown in FIG. 5 or FIG. 6, an embodiment of this application further provides a communication system. FIG. 7 is a diagram of a communication system according to an embodiment of this application. As shown in FIG. 7, a communication system 70 includes a transmitting apparatus 71 (the transmitting apparatus 71 may be the transmitting apparatus 50 shown in FIG. 5 or the transmitting apparatus 60 shown in FIG. 6), a fiber link 72, and a receiving apparatus 73. The fiber link 72 is configured to connect the transmitting apparatus 71 and the receiving apparatus 73. In the communication system 70, dispersion occurs after a modulated optical signal transmitted by the transmitting apparatus 71 is transmitted over a long distance in the fiber link 72, and an optical modulator in the transmitting apparatus may perform pre-compensation on an optical signal to compensate for dispersion, so that quality of the optical signal received by the receiving apparatus 73 is better, to implement high-speed, large-capacity, and long-range communication.

Embodiment 4

[0088] FIG. 8 is a schematic flowchart corresponding to a modulation method according to an embodiment of this application. In this embodiment of this application, the optical modulator in Embodiment 1 or Embodiment 2 may be used to perform the modulation method on an optical signal. As shown in FIG. 8, the modulation method may include the following operations.

[0089] S801: Split an input optical signal into a first optical signal and a second optical signal.

[0090] S802-a: Perform first phase modulation on the first optical signal in a first phase modulation area to obtain a first modulated optical signal.

[0091] S803-a. Adjust a transmission direction of the first modulated optical signal from a first transmission direction

to a second transmission direction, to transmit the first modulated optical signal to the first phase modulation area, where the second transmission direction is opposite to the first transmission direction.

[0092] S804-a. Perform the first phase modulation on the first modulated optical signal in the first phase modulation area to obtain a second modulated optical signal.

[0093] S802-b: Perform second phase modulation on the second optical signal in a second phase modulation area to obtain a third modulated optical signal.

[0094] S803-b: Adjust a transmission direction of the third modulated optical signal from a third transmission direction to a fourth transmission direction, to transmit the third modulated optical signal to the second phase modulation area, where the fourth transmission direction is opposite to the third transmission direction.

[0095] S804-b: Perform the second phase modulation on the third modulated optical signal in the second phase modulation area to obtain a fourth modulated optical signal.

[0096] S805: Combine the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal to form a modulated optical signal, and output the modulated optical signal.

[0097] According to the foregoing method, the first optical signal may be reversely transmitted after undergoing phase modulation once, so that the first optical signal undergoes phase modulation twice back and forth in the first phase modulation area (that is, a phase shift amount of the first optical signal is doubled). Similarly, the second optical signal may be reversely transmitted after undergoing phase modulation once, so that the second optical signal undergoes phase modulation twice back and forth in the second phase modulation area (that is, a phase shift amount of the second optical signal is doubled). Therefore, lengths of the phase modulation areas may be halved, to effectively reduce a size of the optical modulator and improve integration.

[0098] The term “and/or” in embodiments of this application describes an association relationship between associated objects and may indicate three relationships. For example, A and/or B may indicate the following cases: Only A exists, both A and B exist, and only B exists, where A and B may be singular or plural. “At least one item (piece) of the following” or a similar expression thereof refers to any combination of these items, including any combination of singular items (pieces) or plural items (pieces). For example, “at least one of A, B, and C” includes A, B, C, AB, AC, BC, or ABC. In addition, unless otherwise specified, ordinal numbers such as “first” and “second” in embodiments of this application are used to distinguish between a plurality of objects, and are not used to limit a sequence, a time sequence, a priority, or importance of the plurality of objects.

[0099] Reference to “an embodiment”, “some embodiments”, or the like described in this specification indicates that one or more embodiments of this application include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described with reference to this embodiment. Therefore, statements such as “in an embodiment”, “in another embodiment”, “in some embodiments”, “in some other embodiments”, or “in other embodiments” that appear at different places in this specification do not necessarily mean reference to a same embodiment. Instead, the statements mean “one or more but not all of embodiments”, unless otherwise emphasized in another manner. The terms “include”, “have”, and their

variants all mean “include but are not limited to”, unless otherwise emphasized in another manner.

[0100] The foregoing descriptions are merely implementations of this application, but are not intended to limit the protection scope of this application. Any variation or replacement readily figured out by a person skilled in the art within the technical scope disclosed in this application shall fall within the protection scope of this application. Therefore, the protection scope of this application shall be subject to the protection scope of the claims.

[0101] It is clearly that a person skilled in the art can make various modifications and variations to this application without departing from the spirit and scope of this application. This application is intended to cover these modifications and variations of this application provided that they fall within the scope of protection defined by the following claims and their equivalent technologies.

1. An optical modulator, wherein the optical modulator comprises:

- a beam combiner/splitter;
- a first electro-optic phase shifter and a second electro-optic phase shifter connected to the beam combiner/splitter;
- a first reverser connected to the first electro-optic phase shifter; and
- a second reverser connected to the second electro-optic phase shifter, wherein

the beam combiner/splitter is configured to:

- split an input optical signal into a first optical signal and a second optical signal;
- input the first optical signal into the first electro-optic phase shifter; and
- input the second optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter;

the first electro-optic phase shifter is configured to:

- perform first phase modulation on the first optical signal to obtain a first modulated optical signal; and
- input the first modulated optical signal into the first reverser;

the first reverser is configured to:

- adjust a transmission direction of the first modulated optical signal from a first transmission direction to a second transmission direction; and
- input the first modulated optical signal into the first electro-optic phase shifter, wherein the second transmission direction is opposite to the first transmission direction;

the first electro-optic phase shifter is further configured to:

- perform the first phase modulation on the first modulated optical signal to obtain a second modulated optical signal; and
- input the second modulated optical signal into the beam combiner/splitter;

the second electro-optic phase shifter is configured to:

- perform second phase modulation on the second optical signal to obtain a third modulated optical signal; and
- input the third modulated optical signal into the second reverser;

the second reverser is configured to:

- adjust a transmission direction of the third modulated optical signal from a third transmission direction to a fourth transmission direction; and

input the third modulated optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter, wherein the fourth transmission direction is opposite to the third transmission direction;

the second electro-optic phase shifter is further configured to:

- perform the second phase modulation on the third modulated optical signal to obtain a fourth modulated optical signal; and
- input the fourth modulated optical signal into the beam combiner/splitter; and

the beam combiner/splitter is further configured to:

- combine the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal to form a modulated optical signal; and
- output the modulated optical signal.

2. The optical modulator according to claim 1, wherein the first reverser is at least one of a first reflector, a first waveguide loopback device, or a first grating structure; and

the second reverser is at least one of a second reflector, a second waveguide loopback device, or a second grating structure.

3. The optical modulator according to claim 1, wherein a splitting ratio of the first optical signal to the second optical signal is 1:m, $m>0$, and $m\neq 1$.

4. The optical modulator according to claim 1, wherein the beam combiner/splitter is a multimode interferometer.

5. The optical modulator according to claim 1, wherein the optical modulator further comprises a microring resonator array connected to the beam combiner/splitter; and

the microring resonator array is configured to perform delay compensation on the modulated optical signal output by the beam combiner/splitter.

6. A communication system, comprising:

a transmitting apparatus comprising an optical modulator, wherein the optical modulator comprises:

- a beam combiner/splitter;
- a first electro-optic phase shifter and a second electro-optic phase shifter connected to the beam combiner/splitter;
- a first reverser connected to the first electro-optic phase shifter; and
- a second reverser connected to the second electro-optic phase shifter, wherein

the beam combiner/splitter is configured to:

- split an input optical signal into a first optical signal and a second optical signal;
- input the first optical signal into the first electro-optic phase shifter; and
- input the second optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter;

the first electro-optic phase shifter is configured to:

- perform first phase modulation on the first optical signal to obtain a first modulated optical signal; and

input the first modulated optical signal into the first reverser;

the first reverser is configured to:

- adjust a transmission direction of the first modulated optical signal from a first transmission direction to a second transmission direction; and

input the first modulated optical signal into the first electro-optic phase shifter, wherein the second transmission direction is opposite to the first transmission direction;

the first electro-optic phase shifter is further configured to:

- perform the first phase modulation on the first modulated optical signal to obtain a second modulated optical signal; and
- input the second modulated optical signal into the beam combiner/splitter;

the second electro-optic phase shifter is configured to:

- perform second phase modulation on the second optical signal to obtain a third modulated optical signal; and
- input the third modulated optical signal into the second reverser;

the second reverser is configured to:

- adjust a transmission direction of the third modulated optical signal from a third transmission direction to a fourth transmission direction; and
- input the third modulated optical signal into the second electro-optic phase shifter, wherein the fourth transmission direction is opposite to the third transmission direction;

the second electro-optic phase shifter is further configured to:

- perform the second phase modulation on the third modulated optical signal to obtain a fourth modulated optical signal; and
- input the fourth modulated optical signal into the beam combiner/splitter; and

the beam combiner/splitter is further configured to:

- combine the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal to form a modulated optical signal; and
- output the modulated optical signal.

7. The communication system according to claim 6, wherein the transmitting apparatus comprises:

- a beam splitter and N optical modulators connected to the beam splitter, wherein
- the N optical modulators comprise the optical modulator; and
- the beam splitter is configured to split an input optical signal into N optical signals and respectively input the N optical signals into the N optical modulators; and
- an i^{th} optical modulator, in the N optical modulators, configured to:
- perform phase modulation on an i^{th} optical signal in the N optical signals, and
- output an i^{th} modulated optical signal, wherein $i=1, 2, \dots, N$, and N is an integer greater than 1.

8. The communication system according to claim 7, wherein the N optical signals have a same splitting ratio.

9. The communication system according to claim 6, further comprising:

- a receiving apparatus; and
- a fiber link, wherein the fiber link connects the transmitting apparatus and the receiving apparatus.

10. The communication system according to claim 6, wherein

the first reverser is at least one of a first reflector, a first waveguide loopback device, or a first grating structure; and

the second reverser is at least one of a second reflector, a second waveguide loopback device, or a second grating structure.

11. The communication system according to claim 6, wherein a splitting ratio of the first optical signal to the second optical signal is 1:m, $m>0$, and $m \neq 1$.

12. The communication system according to claim 6, wherein the beam combiner/splitter is a multimode interferometer.

13. The communication system according to claim 6, wherein

the optical modulator further comprises a microring resonator array connected to the beam combiner/splitter; and

the microring resonator array is configured to perform delay compensation on the modulated optical signal output by the beam combiner/splitter.

14. A modulation method, wherein the method comprises: splitting an input optical signal into a first optical signal and a second optical signal;

performing, in a first phase modulation area, first phase modulation on the first optical signal to obtain a first modulated optical signal;

adjusting a transmission direction of the first modulated optical signal from a first transmission direction to a second transmission direction;

transmitting the first modulated optical signal to the first phase modulation area, wherein the second transmission direction is opposite to the first transmission direction; and

performing, in the first phase modulation area, the first phase modulation on the first modulated optical signal to obtain a second modulated optical signal;

performing, in a second phase modulation area, second phase modulation on the second optical signal to obtain a third modulated optical signal;

adjusting a transmission direction of the third modulated optical signal from a third transmission direction to a fourth transmission direction;

transmitting the third modulated optical signal to the second phase modulation area, wherein the fourth transmission direction is opposite to the third transmission direction; and

performing, in the second phase modulation area, the second phase modulation on the third modulated optical signal to obtain a fourth modulated optical signal; and

combining the second modulated optical signal and the fourth modulated optical signal to form a modulated optical signal, and outputting the modulated optical signal.

15. The method according to claim 14, wherein

a first reverser performs the adjusting the transmission direction of the first modulated optical signal, the first reverser being at least one of a first reflector, a first waveguide loopback device, or a first grating structure; and

a second reverser performs the adjusting the transmission direction of the third modulated optical signal, the

second reverser being at least one of a second reflector, a second waveguide loopback device, or a second grating structure.

16. The method according to claim **14**, wherein a splitting ratio of the first optical signal to the second optical signal is 1:m, $m > 0$, and $m \neq 1$.

17. The method according to claim **14**, wherein a beam combiner/splitter performs the splitting the input optical signal, the beam combiner/splitter being a multimode interferometer.

18. The method according to claim **17**, wherein the method is performed by an optical modulator, comprising: a microring resonator array connected to the beam combiner/splitter, wherein the microring resonator array is configured to perform delay compensation on the modulated optical signal that is output by the beam combiner/splitter.

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